

Katrin Rohrbacher

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Research Areas

Computational Literary Studies, Computational Narratology, NLP, Large Language Models, Digital Humanities Infrastructure

Academic Appointments

2025– **Postdoctoral Researcher**, Friedrich-Alexander-Universität Erlangen-Nürnberg, Department of Digital Humanities and Social Studies

Education

2018–2025 **PhD**, German Studies, Department of Languages, Literatures, and Cultures, McGill University
Dissertation: *Aspects of Space: Quantitative Approaches to Fictional Worlds* (Advisor: Andrew Piper).

2014–2018 **MA**, Department of Comparative Literature, University of Vienna

2010–2014 **BA**, Department of Comparative Literature, University of Vienna

Grants and Funding

Period	Funding	Amount
08/2026–08/2027	FAU Emerging Talents Initiative (ETI) , “Nature in Motion: A Computational Study of Environmental Representation in Travel Writing” (applicant, awarded).	€15,000
2026	Travel Grant , Office for Gender and Diversity, FAU Erlangen-Nürnberg (awarded)	€500
01/2021–02/2022	Graduate Fellowship , Wolfe Chair for Science and Technology, McGill University	€4,350*
Total funding received		€19,850

* converted from \$5,000

Publications

Rohrbacher, K., Nieth, B., Salin, E., Eskofier, B., Mahlberg, M. (2026). How LLMs Build Fictional Worlds: Measuring Setting and Narrative Space in AI-Generated Creative Storytelling. Proceedings of the 2026 Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing (EMNLP). To appear. Preprint: <https://doi.org/10.48550/arXiv.2609.02482>

Rohrbacher, K., Wagner, A., Mahlberg, M. (2026): “Letting the Cat out of the Bag”: Towards the Automatic Detection of Animal Metaphors in Literary Texts. Book of Abstracts of the DH 2026,

ADHO Annual Conference 2026, South Korea/hybrid, pp.~685–688. <https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.21495909>

Rohrbacher, K. (2026): “Lived Space”: A Computational Study of Setting in Fiction. In: Comparing Landscapes. Approaches to Space and Affect in Literary Fiction. Conference Proceedings. Ed. Berenike Herrmann, Giulia Grisot, Robin Aust. Bielefeld University Press. Forthcoming.

Mahlberg, M. & **Rohrbacher, K.** (2026). Corpora in Digital Humanities and Corpus Linguistics. In: Hilary Nesi & Petar Milin (eds.), *International Encyclopedia of Language and Linguistics*, 3rd Edition. Elsevier, pp.~62–68. <https://doi.org/10.1016/B978-0-323-95504-1.01548-9>

Rohrbacher, K. & Schrittmesser, D. (2026). Bridging the Gaps: Integrating Bibliographic Metadata Into Wikidata for Literary Corpora. *Journal of Open Humanities Data*, 12(1), 37. <https://doi.org/10.5334/johd.483>

Rohrbacher, K. (2025). Opening worlds: Narrative beginnings and the role of setting. CCLS2025 Conference Preprints, 4(1). <https://doi.org/10.26083/tuprints-00030149>.

Rohrbacher, K. (2025). de-Corp: A Corpus of German Fiction and Non-Fiction (1780-1930). *Journal of Open Humanities Data*, 11(1), p. 51. <https://doi.org/10.5334/johd.350>.

Luederitz, C., Animesh, A., **Rohrbacher, K.**, Li, T., Piper, A., Potvin, C., & Etzion, D. (2023). Non-monetary narratives motivate businesses to engage with climate change. *Sustainability Science*, 18(6), 2649–2660. <https://doi.org/10.1007/s11625-023-01386-1>.

IN PREPARATION (INVITED CONTRIBUTIONS)

Mahlberg, M. & **Rohrbacher, K.** (in preparation). [Chapter title to be confirmed]. In: *The Oxford Handbook of Language and Masculinities*. Invited chapter, under contract.

Honors and Awards

12/2021	Hans Walter Frischkopf Award for Excellence in Teaching, McGill University
01/2020	Graduate Excellence Award , McGill University
01/2019	Graduate Excellence Award , McGill University

Academic Service

2025–	Deputy Representative of the mid-level academic staff (PhD students and PostDocs), Department of Digital Humanities and Social Studies, FAU Erlangen-Nuremberg
09/2025	Co-Organizer , DHSS Summer School “Data, Gender, and Society”, FAU Erlangen-Nuremberg
01/2022	Co-Organizer , “7th Annual German Teaching Workshop”, McGill University
03/2021	Co-Organizer , Graduate Research Conference, "Environment: Last Call", McGill University

Teaching

2026	Lecturer , Computing Text and Language, FAU Erlangen-Nuremberg
2026	Lecturer , Critical AI, FAU Erlangen-Nuremberg
2025	Lecturer , Computational Approaches to Storytelling, FAU Erlangen-Nuremberg
2024	Lecturer , Modern Short Fiction, McGill University
2023	Lecturer , The German Novel, McGill University
2018–2024	Lecturer , German Language (Beginners and Intermediate), McGill University

Professional Experience

2019–2025	Managing Editor , Journal of Cultural Analytics, https://culturalanalytics.org
2021–2022	Researcher and Project Management , PIVOT, https://pivot.org/
2017–2018	Curatorial Assistant , Halle für Kunst Steiermark, https://halle-fuer-kunst.at/

Invited Talks

01/2026	<i>Measuring Narrative Space: A Computational Study of German and English Prose Fiction</i> , University of Bielefeld, Kolloquium Literaturwissenschaften Revisited
11/2025	<i>Aspects of Space: Quantitative Evidence and Fictional Worlds</i> , University of Hamburg, DH Lecture Series

Talks and Workshops

07/2026	Talk , ADHO Annual Conference 2026, South Korea, "Towards the Automatic Detection of Animal Metaphors in Literary Texts"
04/2026	Talk , 8th annual COMPTXT conference, University of Birmingham, "Modeling Embodiment in Narratives"
09/2025	Workshop , FAU-Erlangen Nuremberg, DHSS Summer School, "Who is Doing What to Whom: Analyzing Gender Biases in Large Language Models"
07/2025	Talk , Conference of Computational Literary Studies, University of Krakow, "Opening Worlds: Narrative Beginnings and the role of Setting"
03/2024	Talk , AACL Montreal, "Questions of Authorship and Agency in the Age of Machine Learning"
10/2023	Talk , "A Computational Study of Setting in German Fiction, GSA Montreal"
08/2023	Talk , "Literary Data and Digital Literature", Summer School at German Literary Archive Marbach

Mentoring

06/2025- 06/2026	Co-adviser , MA-thesis, Marius Lin, "Framing of Political Discourse in Online Forums", FAU Erlangen-Nuremberg
03/2025- 03/2026	Co-adviser , MA-thesis, Jan-Oliver Reincke, "Climate Change Narratives in Video Game Storytelling: A Text-Based Computational Study of Emotion", FAU Erlangen-Nuremberg